

IE9 Beta launched

IE 9 Beta launched with a fresh look and improved usability and security features

HD Media Players



Buffalo LT V-1005000

Buffalo LT V-100

Buffalo is a brand that's digging deeper into storage and networking devices. The LT-V100 is their latest product. It is a compact looking, jet black HD player with a smooth upper surface.

The build quality of the product is not impressive. The body made of cheap plastic. The remote control bundled with the player is dull colored, flimsy and unimpressive.

There are two USB 2.0 ports and a HDMI connection on the back panel. We wish they had provided us with an HDMI cable though. The nice part is, the remote control, works from any angle. It has a LAN port for home network connection. However, it does not feature Wi-Fi. The user interface is user friendly, but it does not segregate according to their format.

The noise reduction feature is not very effective in reducing the amount of noise in the image rendered on screen. An important thing to note is the ability to play almost the file formats including MP4, MPG, RMVB, MOV, MKV, AVI, but it fails to play FLV. When connected to the network, playback lags and files take time to open. File transferring is quite slow.

At 12,000, it is highly overpriced for its build quality and features. You are better off putting in an additional Rs. 1,500 and getting the Xstreamer Pro with media streaming and other outstanding features.

Compro VideoMate 950

The Compro VideoMate 950 is a full HD media player with net-

work connectivity and storage options. It comes in an all black body and has a nice brush metal finish. The front panel is made of plastic with a USB port positioned in the bottom left hand corner. There is a string of LED indicators as well. The body is somewhat bulkier to accommodate either a 2.5 inch or 3.5 inch SATA hard drives.

VideoMate 950 comes with a range of connectivity options like an HDMI port, a component, composite audio and video ports, two USB ports, a mini USB port and a LAN port for network connectivity. The player can be opened up to to attach the HDD within. The interiors are pretty compact in the sense - there is no noticeable gap once you plug in the drive in the chassis. Provisions are made for a 2.5 inch drive - there are some clips provided to hold it in place.

The GUI is one of the most impressive user interfaces we have seen among all the media players tested up until now. The main home screen shows three options like File Copy - which allows you to copy files among your network, HDD and USB drive; Browser - which segregates the various input media like HDD, USB, Network etc and finally Settings which allows you to tweak the audio, video, network settings.

It takes 11 seconds to startup, but movie loading time is a quick 4 seconds. Navigating through the menus is quite intuitive. It does not segregate media though. The bundled in remote is decent but the navigation pad in the centre requires a hard

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